

The Greeks

1) Delta (δ)

It represents how much an option value will change with \$1 increase in the stock it represents.

Call : $0 \leftrightarrow +1$

Put : $-1 \leftrightarrow 0$

$\Rightarrow$ Higher for "in the money" or profitable options

Lower for "out of the money" or unprofitable options.

$\Rightarrow$ Mathematically, $\Delta = \frac{\partial C}{\partial S}$

It is only for local changes over short period of time. (Local Approx.)

Challenge $\rightarrow \delta$ changes with Stock Price

2) Gamma (γ)

Measures the sensitivity of δ with stock price.

Mathematically,

$$\gamma = \frac{\delta^2 C}{\delta S^2}$$

$\Rightarrow \gamma$ is higher for at the money.

$\Rightarrow \gamma$ is lower for deep in/out of money

In the money (ITM) $\Rightarrow$ Profitable ($S > K$)

At the money (ATM) $\Rightarrow$ Almost same ($S \approx K$)

Out of the money (OTM) $\Rightarrow$ Lose money ($S < K$)

Deep in money $\Rightarrow$ Very Profitable

Deep out of money $\Rightarrow$ Far from Profitable

3) Theta (θ)

=> How much time impacts option value.

=> Every passing day reduces the value.

Buyer $\Rightarrow \theta$ (-ve) Less time to make it profitable

Seller $\Rightarrow \theta$ (+ve) Benefits if option is unused

Mathematically,

$$\theta = \frac{\partial C}{\partial t}$$

=> Theta is higher for at the money.

Lower for Deep In, Out of money.

4) Vega (v)

Measures volatility or unstability of stock price.

=> More randomness is preferred over stable as it makes it more probable to hit strike price.

Mathematically $\Rightarrow$ Implied volatility is used;

$$v = \frac{\partial C}{\partial \sigma}$$

(expected volatility)

$v \Rightarrow$ Higher for ATM, longer terms of maturity

5) Rho (ρ)

Measures change in option value with rate of interest.

+ve for Call options
-ve for Put options

Mathematically,

$$\rho = \frac{\partial C}{\partial r}$$

$\Rightarrow$ Higher for ATM, For Longer Terms

$$\delta_{\text{call}} = N(d_1)$$

$$\delta_{\text{put}} = N(d_1) - 1$$

$$\text{Gamma} = \frac{N'(d_1)}{S \cdot \sigma \cdot \sqrt{T}}$$

$$\text{Theta}_{\text{call}} = - \frac{S \cdot N'(d_1) \cdot \sigma}{2\sqrt{T}} - r K e^{-rt} N(d_2)$$

$$\text{Theta}_{\text{put}} = - \frac{S \cdot N'(d_1) \cdot \sigma}{2\sqrt{T}} + r K e^{-rt} N(-d_2)$$

$$\text{Vega} = S \cdot N'(d_1) \cdot \sqrt{T}$$

$$\text{Rho}_{\text{put}} = -K T e^{-rt} N(-d_2) \quad \text{Rho}_{\text{call}} = K T e^{-rt} N(d_2)$$